ATTACK ON TITAN (SHINGEKI NO KYOJIN)

COMPREHENSIVE NARRATIVE ARCHITECTURE & PLOT SUMMARY

AUTHOR	GENRE	CORE SETTING	CENTRAL THEME
Hajime Isayama	Dark Fantasy / Thriller	Paradis Island / Marley	Freedom & War Cycle

1. PREMISE & WORLD INTRODUCTION

For over a century, the remnants of humanity reside within three concentric 50-meter stone walls—Wall Maria, Wall Rose, and Wall Sina—to protect themselves from giant, man-eating humanoid monsters known as Titans. Humanity believes itself to be the last surviving fraction of mankind. The story centers on Eren Yeager, his adopted sister Mikasa Ackerman, and their best friend Armin Arlert, whose lives are altered forever when their hometown is breached by monstrous entities.

Arc I: The Fall of Shiganshina & Training

Phase 1

In the year 845, a colossal 60-meter Colossal Titan and an Armored Titan suddenly break through Wall Maria's outer defense at Shiganshina. Countless Titans enter, devastating the district. Eren watches in horror as his mother is devoured by a Titan. Swearing absolute vengeance to eradicate every Titan from the earth, Eren joins the 104th Cadet Corps alongside Mikasa and Armin. After years of grueling training, they graduate into the military branches.

Arc II: The Defense of Trost & Awakening

Phase 2

Five years after the initial fall, the Colossal Titan reappears at Trost District, breaching Wall Rose. During the chaos, Eren is swallowed whole by a Titan while saving Armin. Inside the monster's stomach, Eren's rage triggers a unexpected transformation: he manifests as a rogue 15-meter Titan that relentlessly slaughters other Titans. Using this newly discovered power, Eren helps the military seal the breach in Wall Rose, marking humanity's first victory. He is subsequently placed under the custody of the Scout Regiment led by Commander Erwin Smith and Captain Levi.

2. THE INTERNAL THREAT & POLITICAL TURMOIL

Arc III: The Female Titan & Infiltration

Phase 3

During an expedition outside the walls, the Scout Regiment is ambushed by an intelligent Female Titan exhibiting advanced combat skills and targeted intent to capture Eren. Erwin suspects a spy within the military ranks. Through strategic deduction, Armin identifies the Female Titan as their fellow cadet, Annie Leonhart. A brutal battle ensues inside Stohess District within Wall Sina, ending with Annie encasing herself in an impenetrable crystal to prevent interrogation.

Arc IV: Clash of the Titans & Treachery

Phase 4

Titans mysteriously appear inside Wall Rose without a visible breach. During the crisis, cadets Reiner Braun and Bertholdt Hoover shocking reveal themselves to Eren as the Armored Titan and Colossal Titan responsible for the fall of Wall Maria. A fierce battle breaks out, leading to Eren's abduction. During the rescue operation, Eren unconsciously unleashes "The Coordinate"—the power of the Founding Titan—commanding pure Titans to devour the enemy, revealing his power controls all Titans.

3. THE NINE TITANS SYSTEM

As the narrative unfolds, it is revealed that the power of the Titans originates from nine specialized, sentient Titan Shifters passed down through generations of Eldians:

TITAN NAME	KEY ATTRIBUTE / CAPABILITY	PRIMARY HOLDERS
Founding Titan	Commands all Titans and alters Eldian memories/biology	Karl Fritz, Grisha, Eren Yeager
Attack Titan	Sees future memories of successor holders; seeks freedom	Eren Kruger, Grisha, Eren Yeager
Colossal Titan	Massive size (60m), explosive transformation, steam generation	Bertholdt Hoover, Armin Arlert
Armored Titan	Hardened segmented armor plates across body structure	Reiner Braun
Female Titan	Versatile mobility, hardening abilities, attracts pure Titans	Annie Leonhart

4. UPRISING & RECLAIMING WALL MARIA

Arc V: Royal Government Uprising

Phase 5

The Scout Regiment discovers that the royal family ruling within the walls is a puppet regime masking the true royal bloodline: the Reiss family. Lord Rod Reiss attempts to capture Eren and have his daughter Historia devour him to reclaim the Founding Titan. Eren learns his father, Grisha, slaughtered the Reiss family and stole the Founding Titan before forcing Eren to devour him. Rejecting her father's manipulation, Historia overthrows the puppet king, crowns herself Queen, and authorises the Scouts' military coup.

Arc VI: Return to Shiganshina & The Basement Truth

Phase 6

The Scouts launch a major operation to retake Wall Maria. In Shiganshina, they face an ambush by Reiner, Bertholdt, and the Beast Titan (Zeke Yeager). Through Commander Erwin's sacrificial charge and Armin's tactical sacrifice, humanity triumphs. Armin inherits the Colossal Titan by devouring Bertholdt, while Erwin dies. Reaching Eren's basement, the survivors discover photographs and journals revealing the global truth: humanity outside the walls is alive and technologically advanced.

5. THE PARADIGM SHIFT: PARADIS VS. THE WORLD

World Truth Revealed

The people inside the walls are "Eldians" (Subjects of Ymir), a race capable of turning into Titans. 2,000 years prior, Ymir Fritz gained the Titan power. Centuries later, King Karl Fritz fled to Paradis Island with millions of Eldians, erasing their memories to construct a peaceful sanctuary behind the Walls. Outside, the nation of Marley oppresses remaining Eldians and uses them as bio-weapons.

Armed with the revelation that their true enemy is not the mindless Titans but the nation of Marley and a hostile global community that fears Eldians, the Scouts finally reach the ocean at the edge of Paradis Island. Eren looks out across the sea, asking if killing all enemies across the ocean will finally grant them freedom.

6. THE MARLEY INFILTRATION & GLOBAL WAR

Arc VII: Marley Invasion & War Hammer Titan

Phase 7

Following a four-year timeskip, the narrative shifts to Marley. Eren infiltrates Liberio disguised as a wounded soldier. During a festival hosted by Willy Tybur—who declares global war on Paradis—Eren transforms, devouring Tybur and acquiring the War Hammer Titan. The Scout Regiment launches an assault to extract Eren, securing Zeke Yeager, who secretly conspires with Eren. However, Sasha Blouse is killed during the retreat, exposing deep rifts between Eren and his comrades.

Arc VIII: War for Paradis & The Yeagerists

Phase 8

Back on Paradis, Eren grows radicalized and forms a militant faction known as "The Yeagerists," overthrowing the military command. Zeke's true goal is revealed: the "Euthanization Plan" to alter Eldian genetics using the Founding Titan so they can no longer reproduce, peacefully ending the Titan curse. Eren pretends to cooperate with Zeke to access the "Paths"—the dimension linking all Eldians—where he meets the spirit of Ymir Fritz.

7. THE APOCALYPSE & FINAL CLIMAX

Arc IX: The Rumbling & The Global Alliance

Phase 9

In the Paths, Eren rejects Zeke's plan and convinces Ymir to grant him her power by offering her freedom of choice. Eren unleashes "The Rumbling"—awakening tens of thousands of Wall Titans to trample all life outside Paradis. Realizing global omnicide is wrong, a coalition of remaining Scouts (Mikasa, Armin, Levi, Hange) and Marleyan Warriors (Reiner, Annie, Falco) form an alliance to stop Eren. Hange sacrifices herself to buy the alliance time to board an airship to reach Eren's skeletal Titan form.

A battle unfolds on the back of Eren's Founding Titan as he summons past Titan Shifters to defend himself. Armin confronts Zeke in the Paths, convincing him of the value of life, leading Zeke to surrender his life to Levi and halt the Rumbling.

8. RESOLUTION, LEGACY & CONCLUSION

In the final confrontation, Mikasa enters the mouth of Eren's Founding Titan and decapitates Eren, kissing him goodbye. Seeing Mikasa choose duty over love frees Ymir Fritz from her 2,000-year devotion to King Fritz, dissolving the Titan power completely across the world. All Eldians are restored to normal human form, and those who held Titan powers are freed from their shortened lifespans.

> **The Aftermath & Eren's Intentions**
> In a final spiritual conversation with Armin, Eren reveals his true motivations: he saw future memories and realized this path was the only way to eradicate Titans, ensure his friends lived long lives, and frame them as global heroes who saved humanity. Though 80% of the world's population was destroyed, Paradis is left on equal footing with the remaining nations.

9. SUMMARY OF KEY NARRATIVE THEMES

The Cycle of Hatred: The narrative demonstrates how oppression, prejudice, and retaliation create an endless war loop across generations, warning against radical nationalism and demonization of "the other."

The Cost of Freedom: Eren's tragic arc explores the absolute pursuit of freedom. His unwillingness to compromise ultimately turns him into the very monster he swore to destroy in his youth.

Human Connection & Meaning: Through characters like Armin and Mikasa, the story emphasizes that life's value lies not in grand conquests or absolute survival, but in small, meaningful moments shared between people.